

0.0.1 Janavasabha

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Natika at the Brick Hall. At that time, at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away,

janavasabhasuttam

evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā nātike¹ viharati giñ-jakāvasathe. tena kho pana samayena bhagavā parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbatthite kālakate upapattisu byākaroti, kāsiko-salesu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu² kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno ti. paropaññāsaṃ nātikiyā paricārakā abbatthitā kālakatā pañcannaṃ orambhāgiyānaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā opapātikā tattha parinibbāyino anāvattidhammā tasmā lokā. sādhiḱā navuti nātikiyā paricārakā abbatthitā kālakatā tiṇ-

from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

2. The [Natika people] heard of the Natika disciples: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas

ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgado-samohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino saki-deva³ imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhassantaṃ karissanti. sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatītā kālakatā, tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti.

assosum kho nātikiyā paricārakā: bhagavā kira parito parito janapadesu paricārake abbhatīte kālakate upapattīsu byākaroti kāsikosalasu vajjimallesu cetivaṃsesu kurupañcālesu macchasūrasenesu asu amutra upapanno asu amutra upapanno'ti. paro-

and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And

paññāsaṃ nātikiyā
paricārakā abbha-
tītā kālakatā pañ-
cannaṃ orambhā-
giyānaṃ saññoja-
nānaṃ parikkhayā
opapātikā tattha pa-
rinibbāyino anāvatti-
dhammā tasmā lokā.
sādhikā navuti nāti-
kiyā paricārakā ab-
bhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-
ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ
parikkhayā rāgado-
samohānaṃ tanuttā
sakadāgāmino saki-
deva imaṃ lokam
āgantvā dukkhassan-
taṃ karissanti. sāti-
rekāni pañcasatāni
nātikiyā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
tiṇṇaṃ saññojanā-
naṃ parikkhayā so-
tāpannā avinipāta-
dhammā niyatā sam-
bodhiparāyaṇā”ti.
tena ca nātikiyā pa-
ricārakā attamanā
ahesaṃ pamuditā

by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One's answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

3. The venerable Ananda heard: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: "That one arose there, that one arose there." "More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to re-

pītisomanassajātā
bhagavato pañhavey-
yākaraṇaṃ⁴ sutvā.

assosi kho āyasmā
ānando: bhagavā
kira parito parito ja-
napadesu paricārake
abbhatīte kālakate
upapattīsu byākaroti.
kāśikosalesu vajji-
mallesu cetivaṃsesu
kurupañcālesu mac-
chasūrasenesu asu
amutra upapanno
asu amutra upapanno
ti. paropaññāsanā-
tikiyā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
pañcannaṃ oram-
bhāgiyānaṃ sañño-
janānaṃ parikkhaya
opapātikā tattha pa-
rinibbāyino anāvatti-
dhammā tasmā lokā.
sādhikā navuti nāti-
kiyā paricārakā ab-

turn from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

4. Then this occurred to the venerable Ananda: “But there were also these Magadhan

bhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā rāgado-samohānaṃ tanuttā sakadāgāmino saki-deva imaṃ lokam āgantvā dukkhasantaṃ karissanti, sātirekāni pañcasatāni nātikiyā paricārakā abbhatitā kālakatā tiṇṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ parikkhayā sotāpannā avinipātadhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā ti. tena ca nātikiyā paricārakā attamanā ahesuṃ pamuditā pītisomanassajātā bhagavato pañhaveyyākaraṇaṃ sutvā”ti.

atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: ime kho pa-nāpīl ahesuṃ mā-

disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

5. Also this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous

gadhakā paricārakā bahū ceva rattaññū ca abbhatītā kālakatā. suññā maññe aṅgamagadhā aṅga-māgadhakehi² paricārakehi abbhatītehi kālakatehi. te kho panāpi ahesuṃ buddhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā sīlesu paripūrakārino te abbhatītā kālakatā bhagavatā abyākatā. te sampassa³ sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahujano pasīdeyya tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ.

ayaṃ kho panāpi ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhamma-rājā hito brāhmaṇa-gahapatikānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissudaṃ manussā kitta-

lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king's kindom." Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [his birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of him. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn't the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhan dis-

yamānarūpā viharanti 'evaṃ no so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayaṃ tassa dhammikaṃ dhammarañño vijite phāsu⁴ viharimhā'ti. so kho panāpi ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudaṃ manussā evamāhaṃsu 'yāva maraṇakālāpi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro bhagavantaṃ kittayamānarūpo kālakato'ti. so abbhatīto kālakato bhagavatā abyākato. tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ. bahujano paṣīdeyya, tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ. bhagavato kho pana sambodhi magadhesu. yattha kho

ciples who have died and passed away, that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

6. The venerable Ananda, having pondered over this [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples, having risen during the night before dawn, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to

bhagavato sambodhi magadhesu, katham tattha bhagavā māgadhave paricāraṇe abbatthāte kālakaṭṭhe upapattīsū na byākareyya? bhagavā ceva kho pana māgadhave paricāraṇe abbatthāte kālakaṭṭhe upapattīsū na byākareyya dīnamanā tenassu māgadhakā paricāraṇā. yena kho panassu dīnamanā māgadhakā paricāraṇā katham te bhagavā na byākareyyāti.

idamāyasmā ānando māgadhave paricāraṇe ārabba eko raho anuvicintetvā rattiyā paccūsasamayam paccuṭṭhāya yena bhagavā tenu-pasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā

one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Ananda said this to the Auspicious One:

7. This, O Bhante, was heard by me: “Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenas: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from

ekamantaṃ nisīdi.
ekamantaṃ nisinno
kho āyasmā ānando
bhagavantaṃ etada-
voca:

sutammetaṃ bhante
bhagavā kira parito
parito janapadesu
paricārake abbha-
tīte kālakate upa-
pattīsu byākaroti
kāsikosalesu vajji-
mallesu cetivaṃsesu
kurupañcālesu mac-
chasūrasenesu. asu
amutra upapanno
asu amutra upapanno
ti. paropaññāsaṃ
nātikiyā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
pañcannaṃ oram-
bhāgiyānaṃ sañño-
janānaṃ parikkhayā
opapātikā tattha pa-
rinibbāyino anāvatti-
dhammā tasmā lokā.
sādhikā navuti nāti-
kiyā paricārakā ab-
bhatītā kālakatā tiṇ-

that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.”

8. But there were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long

ṇaṃ saññojanānaṃ
parikkhayā rāgado-
samohānaṃ tanuttā
sakadāgāmino saki-
deva imaṃ lokam
āgantvā dukkhas-
santaṃ karissanti.
sātirekāni pañcasa-
tāni nātikiyā paricā-
rakā abbhatitā kāla-
katā tiṇṇaṃ sañño-
janānaṃ parikkhayā
sotāpannā avinipā-
tadhammā niyatā
sambodhiparāyaṇāti.
tena ca nātikiyā pa-
ricārakā attamanā
ahesaṃ pamuditā
pītisomanassajātā
bhagavato pañhavey-
yākaraṇaṃ sutvāti.

ime kho panāpi bhante
ahesaṃ māgadhakā
paricārakā bahū ceva
rattaññū ca abbha-
titā kālakatā suññā

standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

9. Also, O Bhante, this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much

maññe aṅgamagadhā aṅgamāgadha-kehi paricārakehi abbhātītehi kālaktehi. te kho panāpi bhante ahesuṃ buddhe pasannā dhamme pasannā saṅghe pasannā sīlesu paripūrakārino. te abbhātītā kālakatā bhagavatā abyākatā. te sampassa sādhu veyyākaraṇaṃ bahujaṇo paśideyya tato gaccheyya sugatiṃ.

ayaṃ kho panāpi bhante, ahosi rājā māgadho seniyo bimbisāro dhammiko dhammarājā hito brāhmaṇagahapati-kānaṃ negamānañceva jānapadānañca. apissudaṃ manussā kittayamānarūpā viharanti. ‘evaṃ no

happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king's kindom." Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] has died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [his birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of him. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn't the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhan disciples who have died and

so dhammiko dhammarājā sukhāpetvā kālakato, evaṃ mayam tassa dhammikkassa dhammarañño vijite phāsu viharimhā'ti. so kho panāpi bhante, ahosi buddhe pasanno dhamme pasanno saṅghe pasanno sīlesu paripūrakārī. apissudam manussā evamāhaṃsu 'yāva maraṇakālā pi rājā magadho seniyo bimbi-sāro bhagavantam kittayamānarūpo kālakato'ti. so abbhātito kālakato bhagavatā abyākato, tassa passa sādhu veyyākaraṇam bahunano pasideyya tato gaccheyya sugatim, bhagavato kho pana bhante, sambodhi magadhesu. yattha kho pana bhante, bhagavato sambodhi

passed away, that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn't the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?"

magadhesu katham
tattha bhagavā mā-
gadhake paricārake
abbhatīte kālakate
upapattīsu na byā-
kareyya. bhagavā
ce kho pana bhante,
māgadhake paricā-
rake abbhatīte kā-
lakate upapattīsu
na byākareyya, dī-
namanā 1 tenassu
māgadhakā paricā-
rakā. yena kho pa-
nassu bhante, dīna-
manā māgadhakā
paricārakā, katham
te bhagavā na byāka-
reyyā"ti.

10. The venerable Ananda, having made this suggestion regarding the Magadhan disciples in front of the Auspicious One, having risen up from his seat, having bowed down, having circumambulated the Auspicious One, he departed.

idamāyasmā ānando
māgadhake paricā-
rake ārabha bha-
gavato sammukhā
parikatham katvā
uṭṭhāyāsanā bhaga-
vantam abhivādetvā
padakkhiṇam katvā
pakkāmi.

11. Then the Auspicious One, not long after the venerable Ananda had left, having dressed in the morning, having taken bowl and robe, entered Natika for alms food. Having wandered in Natika for alms food, after his meal, having gone back after alms gathering, having washed his feet, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples his aim, having attended to it with all his mind, he sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” “The Auspicious One saw the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.” Then in the evening, the Auspicious One, having emerged from seclusion, having gone out of the Brick Hall, sat down on a prepared seat in the shade of the

atha kho bhagavā acirapakkante āyasmante ānande pubbanhasamayam nivāsetvā pattacivaramādāya nātikam piṇḍāya pāvisi. nā-tike piṇḍāya caritvā pacchābhataṃ piṇḍapātapatikkanto pāde pakkhāletvā giṇṇakāvasathaṃ pavisitvā māgadhake paricārake ārabha atthikatvā manasi katvā sabbam cetesā samannāharitvā paññatte āsane nisīdi “gatim tesam jānis-sāmi abhisamparāyam yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyā”ti. ad-dasā kho bhagavā māgadhake paricārake yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisamparāyāti. atha kho bhagavā sāyanhasamayam paṭisal-

dwelling.

12. Then the venerable Ananda approached the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Ananda said this to the Auspicious One: “The Auspicious One, O Bhante, has a peaceful appearance, for the Auspicious One’s facial complexion is bright, showing clearness of the faculties. Surely, O Bhante, the Auspicious One dwelled in a peaceful abiding today.”

13. “Just that which you, O Ananda, having made the suggestion regarding the Magadhan disciples in front of

lānā vuṭṭhito giñjakā-vasathā nikkhamitvā vihārapacchāyāyaṃ paññatte āsane nisīdi.

atha kho āyasmā ānando yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho āyasmā ānando bhagavantam etadavoca. “upasantapadisso¹ bhante bhagavā, bhātiriva bhagavato mukhavaṇṇo vipprasannattā indriyānaṃ. santena nūnajja bhante bhagavā vihārena vihāsī”ti.

“yadeva kho me tvaṃ ānanda, māgadhake paricārake ārabha sammukhā parikaṭṭhaṃ katvā utthāyā-

me, having risen up from your seat, and departed, it is thus, that I, having wandered in Natika for alms food, after my meal, having gone back after alms gathering, having washed my feet, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples my aim, having attended to it with all my mind, I sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” “I saw the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.”

14. Then O Ananda, an invisible Yakkha announced aloud: “I am Janavasabha, O Auspicious One, I am Janavasabha, O Well-farer.” Have you, O

sanā pakkanto, ta-devāhaṃ nātike piṇḍāya caritvā pacchābhataṃ piṇḍapāta-paṭikkanto pāde pak-khāletvā giṇḍakāva-sathaṃ pavisitvā mā-gadhake paricārake ārabba aṭṭhikavā² manasi katvā sabbaṃ cetesā saman-nāharitvā paññatte āsane nisīdiṃ ‘ga-tiṃ tesam jānissāmi abhisamparāyaṃ, yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisam-parāyā’ti. addasaṃ kho ahaṃ ānanda, māgadhake paricārake yaṃgatikā te bhavanto yaṃabhisam-parāyāti.

atha kho ānanda, antarahito yakkho saddamanussāvesi: ‘janavasabho ahaṃ bhagavā, janavasa-bho ahaṃ sugatā’ti.

Ananda, not known or heard [anyone] from here who formerly bore such a name, that is “Janavasabha?”

“abhijānāsi no tvam ānanda, ito pubbe evarūpaṃ nāmadhey-yaṃ sutam yadidaṃ janavasabho”ti.

15. “I, O Bhante, have not known or heard [anyone] from here who formerly bore such a name, that is Janavasabha?” Nevertheless, O Bhante, my body hair stood up, having heard of a bearer of the name, “Janavasabha.” Of me, O Bhante, this occurred: “Surely indeed, whoever bears this well-declared name, that is, “Janavasabha,” will not be a low ranking Yakkha.”

“na kho ahaṃ bhante, abhijānāmi ito pubbe evarūpaṃ nāmadhey-yaṃ sutam yadidaṃ janavasabho”ti. api ca me bhante, lomāni haṭṭhāni janavasabho ti nāmadhey-yaṃ sutvā. tassa mayhaṃ bhante, etadahosi: na hi nūna so orako yakkho bhavissati yassidaṃ³ evarūpaṃ nāmadhey-yaṃ supaññattaṃ yadidaṃ janavasabho’ti.

16. Immediately, O Ananda, after the manifestation of the sound, a Yakkha of extraordinary beauty appeared in front of me. Also for a second

“anantarā kho ānanda, saddapātubhāvā ulāra-vaṇṇo me yakkho sammukhe pātura-hosi. dutiyampi sad-damanussāvesi: ‘bim-

time he announced aloud: “I am Bimbisara, O Auspicious One, I am Bimbisara, O Well-farer.” “This, O Bhante, is the seventh time that I have arisen in companionship with the great king Vessavana. I passed away from there as a king of human beings to come into being [here]. Seven from here, seven from there, I know fourteen abodes of wandering on, where my former abodes were. For a long time, O Bhante, I have known myself to be one free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership.”

17. “This is magnificent of the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha, this is unprecedented of the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha that you say: “For a long time, O Bhante, I have known myself to be one

bisāro ahaṃ bhagavā bimbisāro ahaṃ sugatā’ti. idaṃ sat-tamaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, vessavaṇassa mahārājassa saha-byataṃ upapajjāmi. so tato cuto manus-sarājā bhavitum pahomi.⁴ ito satta tato satta saṃsārāni cattuddasa, nivāsambhijānāmi yattha me vusitaṃ pure. dīgharattaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, avinipāto avinipātaṃ sañjānāmi. āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati saka-dāgāmitāyā ti.

“acchariyamidaṃ āyasmato janavasabhassa yakkhassa, abbhutamidaṃ āyasmato janavasabhassa yakkhassa. ‘dīgharattaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, avinipāto

free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership.”

But from where as the source does the venerable Yakkha Janavasabha know of such a great attainment of distinction?”

18. Not apart from your instructions, O Auspicious One, not apart from your instructions, O Well-farer. Since the day, O Bhante, I attained the higher faith of certainty in the Auspicious One, since then I, O Bhante, have known for a long time to be one free from the lower worlds, not liable to be born in the lower worlds, and the desire has arisen in me to be settled in once-returnership. Here, O Bhante, I was sent by the great king Vessavana to the presence of the great king, Virulha on some celes-

avinipātaṃ sañjānā-mīti ca vadesi, āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati sakadāgāmitāyāti ca vadesi. kuto nidānaṃ panāyasmā janavasabho yakkho evarūpaṃ ulāraṃ visesādhigamaṃ sañjānātī?”ti.

“na aññattha bhagavā tava sāsanaṃ, na aññattha sugata tava sāsanaṃ. yadagge ahaṃ bhante, bhagavati ekantikato¹ abhippasanno, tadagge ahaṃ bhante, dīgharattaṃ avinipāto avinipātaṃ sañjānāmi. āsā ca pana me santiṭṭhati sakadāgāmitāya. idhāhaṃ bhante, vessavaṇena mahārājena pesito virūlhakassa mahārājassa santike kenacidevaka-raṇīyena. addasaṃ

tial business. On the way, I saw that the Auspicious One, having entered the Brick Hall, having made the [matter] regarding the Magadhan disciples his aim, having attended to it with all his mind, he sat down on a prepared seat [thinking]: “I will find out the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy ones, that which is their destiny, their after-death state.” But this, O Bhante, is not a wonder, in that I heard this in the presence of the great king Vessavana’s assembly, I learned this in his presence when he spoke about the destiny, the after-death state of those worthy Magadhan disciples.” Of me, O Bhante, this occurred: “I must see the Auspicious One and I will inform this to the Auspicious One.” These, O Bhante, are the two reasons for me having approached to see the Auspicious One.

bhagavantam anta-
rāmagge giñjakāva-
satham pavisitvā mā-
gadhake paricārake
ārabbha aṭṭhikatvā
manasikatvā sab-
bam cetesā saman-
nāharitvā nisinnam
‘gatiṃ tesam jānis-
sāmi abhisamparā-
yam yaṃgatikā te
bhavanto yaṃabhi-
samparāyāti. anac-
chariyam kho pa-
netam bhante, yaṃ
vessavaṇassa mahā-
rājassa tassaṃ pari-
sāyam bhāsato sam-
mukhā sutam sam-
mukhā paṭiggahitam
yaṃgatikā te bha-
vanto yaṃabhisam-
parāyāti. tassa may-
ham bhante, etada-
hosi: bhagavantañca
dakkhāmi. idañca
bhagavato āroces-
sāmīti. ime kho me
bhante, dve paccayā
bhagavantam das-

19. Formerly, O Bhante, in earlier days, during the Up-satha day, the night of the fifteenth full moon day, at the beginning of the rains retreat, the entire devas of the Tavatimsa, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, the great assembly of devas was seated all around. All of them having assembled, were seated together. The four great kings, sat in the four directions; with the great king Dhatarattha seated in the eastern direction facing west, with the devas in front; the great king Virulha seated in the southern direction facing north, with the devas in front; the great king Virupakkha seated in the western direction facing east, with the devas in front; the great king Vessavana seated in the northern

sanāya upasaṅkamtum.

purimāni bhante, divasāni purimatarāni tadahuposathe paṇṇarase vas-sūpanāyikāya puṇṇāya puṇṇamāya rattiyā kevalakappā ca devā tāvatimsā sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnā honti sannipatitā, mahatī ca dibbaparīsā² samantato sannisinnā honti³ sannipatitā. cattāro ca mahārājāno catud-disā nisinnā honti. puratthimāya disāya dhatarattho mahārājā pacchimābhimukho⁴ nisinno hoti deve purakkhatvā. dakkhiṇāya disāya virūlhako mahārājā uttarābhimukho nisinno hoti deve purakkhatvā. pacchi-

direction facing south, with the devas in front. When, O Bhante, the entire devas of the Tavatimsa, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, the great assembly of devas was seated all around. All of them having assembled, are seated together, and the four great kings having sat in the four directions, for them this is how they are seated. Then behind them come our seats. Those devas, O Bhante, who having fared the life of purity under the Auspicious One, have recently arisen in this Tavatimsa group, those simply outshine other devas in beauty and glory. By that indeed, O Bhante, the Tavatimsa devas, being pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness [declared], “Verily, dear Sir, the celestial group is increasing, the asurā group is declining.” Then, O Bhante, Sakka, ruler of the devas, having known the satisfaction of the Tavatimsa

māya disāya virūpakkho mahārājā puratthābhimukho⁵ nisinno hoti deve purakkhatvā. uttarāya disāya vessavaṇo mahārājā dakkhiṇābhimukho nisinno hoti deve purakkhatvā. yadā bhante, kevalakappā ca devā tāvatimsā sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnā honti sannipatitā mahatī ca dibbaparisā samantato sannisinnā honti sannipatitā, cattāro ca mahārājāno cattuddisā nisinnā honti. idaṃ tesam hoti āsanasmim. atha pacchā amhākaṃ āsanam hoti. ye te bhante, devā bhagavati brahmacariyaṃ caritvā adhunūpapannā tāvatimsakāyaṃ, te aññe deve atirocanti vaṇṇena ceva ya-

devas, rejoiced with these verses:

Indeed, dear Sir, the
Tavatimsa devas re-
joice,
together with their ruler;
revering the Tathagata,
and the excellence of the
Dhamma.

Seeing new devas,
endowed with beauty
and glory;
having fared the life of
purity,
have come here to a

sasā ca. tenassu-
daṃ bhante, devā
tāvatiṃsā attamanā
honti pamuditā pīti-
somanassajātā, “dibbā
vata bho kāyā pa-
ripūranti hāyanti
asurā kāyā”ti. atha
kho bhante, sakko
devānamindo devā-
naṃ tāvatimsānaṃ
sampasādaṃ veditvā
imāhi gāthāhi anu-
modi:

modanti vata bho devā,
tāvatiṃsā sahindakā¹;
tathāgataṃ namas-
santā,
dhammassa ca su-
dhammataṃ.

nave deve ca passantā,
vaṇṇavante yasa-
sine,²
sugatasmim brahma-
cariyaṃ,

good birth.

They outshining others,
with beauty and with
glory;
disciples of extensive
wisdom,
distinguished here.

Having seen this, Tava-
timsa rejoice,
together with their ruler;
revering the Tathagata,
and the excellence of the
Dhamma.

20. From that indeed, O
Bhante, the Tavatimsa devas,
being even more pleased,
greatly delighted, full of joy
and happiness [declared],
“Verily, dear Sir, the celestial
group is increasing, the asurā
group is declining.”

21. Then, O Bhante, the
Tavatimsa devas, having
deliberated the purpose for

caritvāna idhāgate.

te aññe atirocanti,
vaṇṇena yasasāyunā;
sāvakā bhūripaññassa,

visesūpagatā idha.

idaṃ disvāna nan-
danti,
tāvatimsā sahindakā;
tathāgataṃ namas-
santā,
dhammassa ca su-
dhammatanti.

tena sudam bhante,
devā tāvatimsā bhiy-
yosomattāya atta-
manā honti pamu-
ditā pītisomanassa-
jātā ‘dibbā vata bho
kāyā paripūranti hā-
yanti asurā kāyā’ti.

atha kho bhante, ye-
natthena devā tāva-
timsā sudhammā-
yaṃ sabhāyaṃ san-

which they have assembled at the Sudhamma hall, [for which] the great assembly of devas was seated all around, having discussed that purpose, they informed the four great kings about the meaning of what was said. The four great kings having been informed of the meaning of what was said, each stood by his own seat, not having departed.

“Those kings being informed of what was said,
received the instructions;
serene in mind, at peace,
standing by their own
seats.”

22. Then, O Bhante, from the northern quarter a vast light emerged, a radiance became manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Then, O Bhante, Sakka, ruler of the devas,

nisinnā honti sannipatitā, taṃ atthaṃ cintayitvā taṃ atthaṃ mantayitvā vuttavacanāpi taṃ³ cattāro mahārājāno tasmim atthe honti. paccanusitṭhavacanāpi⁴ taṃ cattāro mahārājāno tasmim atthe honti, sakesu sakesu āsanesu ṭhitā avipakkantā.⁵

“te vuttavākyā rājāno,
paṭiggayhānusāsanim;
vippasannamanā santā,
aṭṭhaṃsu samhi āsane”ti.

atha kho bhante, uttarāya disāya ulāro āloko sañjāyi, obhāso pāturahosi, atikkameva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. atha kho bhante, sakko devānamindo deve

addressed the Tavatimsa devas. “When, dear Sirs, that sign is seen, emergence of a vast light, manifestation of a radiance [it indicates that] Brahma will appear. Indeed this is the foresign of the appearance of Brahma, that is the emergence of light, the manifestation of radiance.”

“When the sign is seen,
Brahma will appear;
Indeed, this is the sign of
Brahma,
a great and vast radi-
ance.”

23. So then, O Bhante, each one of the Tavatimsa devas sat in his own seat [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.” The four great kings too, each one sat in his own

tāvatimse āmantesi.
yathā kho mārīsā
nimittāni dissanti
ulāro āloko sañjāyati.
obhāso pātubhavati,
brahmā pātubhavis-
sati, brahmuno he-
taṃ pubbanimittam
pātubhāvāya yadi-
dam āloko sañjāyati
obhāso pātubhavatī
ti.

“yathā nimittā dis-
santi,
brahmā pātubhavis-
sati;
brahmuno hetam ni-
mittam,
obhāso vipulo ma-
hāti.”

atha kho bhante,
devā tāvatimsā ya-
thāsakesu āsanesu
nisīdimsu ‘obhāsa-
metam ñassāma yaṃ-
vipāko bhavissati
sacchikatvā’va naṃ
gamiṣāmā ti. cat-

seat [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.” Having heard this, the Tavatimsa devas entered upon one accord [thinking]: “We will find out what the result of this radiance will be, only having realized that will we go.”

24. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he appears having created a gross self-begetting, since, O Bhante, Brahma’s natural appearance is imperceivable to the Tavatimsa devas range of vision. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he simply outshines other devas in beauty and glory. Just as, O Bhante, a figure of gold

tāro pi mahārājāno yathāsakesu āsānesu nisīdiṃsu “obhāsametaṃ ñassāma yaṃvipāko bhavisati, sacchikatvā’va naṃ gamissāmā’ti. idaṃ sutvā devā tāvatimsā ekaggā samāpajjīṃsu “obhāsametaṃ ñassāma, yaṃvipāko bhavisati, sacchikatvā’va naṃ gamissāmā”ti.

yadā bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati oḷārikāṃ attabhāvaṃ abhinimminivā pātubhavati. yo kho pana bhante, brahmuno pakativaṇṇo, anabhisambhavanīyo so devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ cak-khupathasmiṃ. yadā bhante, brahmā sanāṃkumāro devā-

outshines the figure of a human, so too, O Bhante, when Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, he simply outshines other devas in beauty and glory. When, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara appears to the Tavatimsa devas, no deva in that assembly bows down to him, or rises from his seat, or offer him a seat. They all simply sit down quietly in cross-legged position with hands in anjali [thinking]: “Now of whichever deva Brahma Sanankumara will wish, he will sit on that deva’s seat.” And of the deva, O Bhante, whose seat Brahma Sanankumara sits down, that deva gains the attainment of a great feeling, that deva gains the attainment of great joy. Just as, O Bhante, a head-annointed Khattiya king being coronated gains the attainment of a great feeling, gains the attainment of great joy, so too, O Bhante, that

naṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati so aññe deve atirocati vaṇṇena ceva yasasā ca. seyyathāpi bhante, sovaṇṇo viggaho mānusaṃ viggahaṃ atirocati, evameva kho bhante yadā brahmā sanaṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati, so aññe deve atirocati vaṇṇena ceva yasasā ca. yadā bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ pātubhavati, na tassaṃ parisāyaṃ koci devo abhivādeti vā paccuṭṭheti vā āsānena vā nimanteti. sabbeva tuṇhībhūtā pañjalikā pallākena nisīdanti ‘yassadā’ni devassa icchissati brahmā sanaṃkumāro tassa devassa pallāke nisīdissatī’ti.

deva gains the attainment of a great feeling, that deva gains the attainment of great joy.

yassa kho pana bhante,
devassa brahmā sa-
naṃkumāro pallaṅke
nisīdati, uḷāraṃ so
labhati devo veda-
paṭilābhaṃ uḷāraṃ
so labhati devo so-
manassapaṭilābhaṃ.
seyyathāpi bhante,
rājā khattiyo mud-
dhāvasitto adhunā-
bhisitto rajjena, uḷā-
raṃ so labhati veda-
paṭilābhaṃ, uḷāraṃ
so labhati somanas-
sapaṭilābhaṃ, eva-
meva kho bhante,
yassa devassa brahmā
sanaṃkumāro pal-
laṅke nisīdati uḷā-
raṃ so labhati devo
vedapaṭilābhaṃ. uḷā-
raṃ so labhati devo
somanassapaṭilā-
bhaṃ.

25. Then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having created a gross self-begetting having

atha bhante, brahmā
sanaṃkumāro oḷā-
rikaṃ attabhāvaṃ
abhinimminivā ku-

taken on the appearance of the young boy Pancasikha, appeared to the Tavatimsa devas. He, having flown up into the air, sat down cross-legged in the air. Just as, O Bhante, a strong man might easily spread out his crossed legs evenly or sit down on the ground cross-legged, so too, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having flown up into the air, sat down cross-legged in the air. Having known the satisfaction of the Tavatimsa devas, he rejoiced with these verses:

Indeed, dear Sir, the
Tavatimsa devas re-
joice,
together with their ruler;
revering the Tathagata,
and the excellence of the
Dhamma.

māraṇṇī hutvā
pañcasikho devānaṃ
tāvatimsānaṃ pātu-
rahosi. so vehāsaṃ
abbhuggantvā ākāse
antaḷikkhe pallaṅ-
kena nisīdi. seyya-
thāpi bhante, balavā
puriso supaccatthate
vā pallaṅke same vā
bhūmibhāge pallaṅ-
kena nisīdeyya, eva-
meva kho bhante,
brahmā sanaṃku-
māro vehāsaṃ ab-
bhuggantvā ākāse
antaḷikkhe pallaṅ-
kena nisīditvā devā-
naṃ tāvatimsānaṃ
sampasādaṃ veditvā
imāhi gāthāhi anu-
modi:

modanti vata bho devā,
tāvatimsā sahindakā1;
tathāgataṃ namas-
santā,
dhammassa ca su-

Seeing new devas,
endowed with beauty
and glory;
having fared the life of
purity,
have come here to a
good birth.

They outshining others,
with beauty and with
glory;
disciples of extensive
wisdom,
distinguished here.

Having seen this, Tava-
timsa rejoice,
together with their ruler;
revering the Tathagata,
and the excellence of the
Dhamma.

26. This, O Bhante, is the
meaning of what Brahma
Sanankumara spoke. As, O
Bhante, the Brahma Sananku-
mara was speaking this mean-

dhammataṃ.

nave deve ca passantā,
vaṇṇavante yasa-
sine,²;
sugatasmim̐ brahma-
cariyaṃ,
caritvāna idhāgate.

te aññe atirocanti,
vaṇṇena yasaṣāyunā;
sāvaka bhūripaññassa,
visesūpagatā idha.

idaṃ disvāna nan-
danti,
tāvatiṃsā sahindakā;
tathāgataṃ nama-
santā,
dhammassa ca su-
dhammatanti.

idamatthaṃ bhante,
brahmā sanaṃku-
māro bhāsittha. ida-
matthaṃ bhante,
brahmuno sanaṃ-

ing, the sound was endowed with eight factors: It was distinct and intelligible, sweet and lovely to hear, rich and not discordant, deep and melodious, yet, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara's voice was audible to the extent of the assembly. His voice did not pass on outside of the assembly. He whose voice, O Bhante, is thus endowed with eight factors, is said to have the "voice of Brahma." Then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having created a self-begetting of thirty three [Pancasikhas], having sat down cross-legged individually by each of the Tavatimsa devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas:

kumārassa bhāsato
 aṭṭhaṅgasamannā-
 gato saro hoti: vis-
 saṭṭho ca viññeyyo
 ca mañju ca sava-
 nīyo ca bindu ca avi-
 sārī ca gambhīro ca
 ninnādī ca. yathā-
 parisam kho pana
 bhante, brahmā sa-
 naṃkumāro sarena
 viññāpeti. na cassa
 bahiddhā parisāya
 ghoso niccharati.
 yassa kho pana bhante,
 evaṃ aṭṭhaṅgasa-
 mannāgato saro hoti,
 so vuccati 'brahmas-
 saro'ti. atha kho
 bhante, brahmā sa-
 naṃkumāro tettiṃsa
 attabhāve abhinim-
 mitvā devānaṃ
 tāvatimsānaṃ pac-
 cekapallaṅkesu pac-
 cekapallaṅkena nisī-
 ditvā deve tāvatimse
 āmantesi:

"taṃ kimmaññanti

27. “What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the Auspicious One has treaded on the path for the welfare of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the benefit, welfare and happiness of devas and humans. Indeed Sirs, whoever has gone to the Buddha as refuge, gone to the Dhamma as refuge, gone to the Sangha as refuge, and has fulfilled the virtues, with the breakup of the body after death, some have arisen in the companionship of the Paranimmitavasavatti devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Nimmanarati devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Tusita devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Yama devas, some have arisen in the companionship of the Tavatimsa devas, some have arisen in the com-

bhonto devā tāva-
tiṃsā. yāvañca so
bhagavā bahujana-
hitāya paṭipanno ba-
hujanasukhāya lokā-
nukampāya atthāya
hitāya sukhāya deva-
manussānaṃ. ye hi
keci bho buddhaṃ
saraṇaṃ gatā dham-
maṃ saraṇaṃ gatā
saṅghaṃ saraṇaṃ
gatā sīlesu paripū-
rakārino, te kāyassa
bhedā parammaraṇā
appekacce paranim-
mitavasavattīnaṃ
devānaṃ saha-
byataṃ upapajjanti ap-
pekacce nimmānara-
tīnaṃ devānaṃ saha-
byataṃ upapajjanti,
appekacce tusitā-
naṃ devānaṃ saha-
byataṃ upapajjanti,
appekacce yāmānaṃ
devānaṃ saha-
byataṃ upapajjanti, ap-
pekacce tāvatimsā-
naṃ devānaṃ saha-

panionship of the Four Great Kings. Those who have fulfilled the very lowest, fill up the host of gandhabbas.”

28. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. As, O Bhante, the Brahma Sanankumara was speaking this meaning, the devas conceived only his voice [thinking]: “Whoever is seated on my seat speak this to me alone.”

When one is speaking,
all the creations speaks;
when one is being silent,
they all become silent.

byataṃ upapajjanti,
appekacce cātum-
mahārājikānaṃ de-
vānaṃ sahaḃyataṃ
upapajjanti, ye sab-
banihīnaṃ kāyaṃ
paripūrenti, te gan-
dhabbakāyaṃ pari-
pūrentī ti.

idamatthaṃ bhante,
brahmā sanaṃku-
māro bhāsīttha. ida-
matthaṃ bhante brah-
muno sanaṃkumā-
rassa bhāsato gho-
so yeva. devā maññanti
yavāyaṃ mama pal-
laṅke, svāyaṃ eko’va
bhāsatī’ti.

“ekasmiṃ bhāsamā-
nasmiṃ,
sabbe bhāsanti nim-
mitā;
ekasmiṃ tuṇhimā-
sīne,
sabbe tuṇhībhavanti
te.

Then even the Tavatimsa
devas,
together with their ruler
conceive;
whoever is seated on my
seat,
speak this to me alone.”

29. Then, O Bhante, Brahma
Sanankumara brought to-
gether [those creations] into
one. Having brought together
[those creations] into one,
having sat down cross-legged
on Sakka’s seat, he addressed
the Tavatimsa devas:

30. What do you think
about that, O honorable
devas of Tavatimsa, the ex-
tent to which the declaration
of the four bases for superhu-
man powers has been well de-
clared by the Auspicious One
who knows and sees, the Ara-
hant, the Supremely Awak-

tadā su devā mañ-
ñanti,
tāvatimsā sahindakā;
yvāyaṃ mama pallaṅ-
kasiṃ,
svāyaṃ eko’va bhā-
satī ti.”

atha kho bhante,
brahmā sanamku-
māro ekattena at-
tānaṃ upasaṃhāsi.
ekattena attānaṃ
upasaṃharitvā sak-
kassa devānamin-
dassa pallaṅke pal-
laṅkena nisīditvā
deve tāvatimse āman-
tesī:

taṃ kimmaññanti
bhonto devā tāva-
timśā yāvasupañ-
ñattā cime tena bha-
gavatā jānatā pas-
satā arahatā sam-
māsambuddhena
cattāro iddhipādā
paññattā iddhipahu-
tāya iddhivisavitāya

ened One, for the possession of superhuman powers, for the mastery of superhuman powers, for the versatility of superhuman powers. Which four?

31. Here Sirs, a bhikkhu enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with desire-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with energy-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with samadhi-state-of-mind and the will-power for exertion. He enculturates the bases for superhuman power endowed with investigation-samadhi and the will-power for exertion. These, Sirs, are the four bases for superhuman powers that has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows

iddhivikubbanatāya.
katame cattāro?

idha bho bhikkhu
chandasaṃdhīpa-
dhāna-saṅkhāra-
saṃnāgataṃ iddhi-
pādaṃ bhāveti, viri-
ya-saṃdhīpa-
dhāna-saṅkhāra-
saṃnāgataṃ iddhi-
pādaṃ bhāveti, citta-saṃ-
dhīpa-
dhāna-saṅkhāra-
saṃnāgataṃ id-
dhipādaṃ bhāveti,
vīmaṃsā-saṃdhīpa-
dhāna-saṅkhāra-
saṃnāgataṃ iddhi-
pādaṃ bhāveti. ime
kho bho tena bhaga-
vatā jānatā passatā
arahatā sammāsa-
mābuddhena cattāro
iddhipādā paññattā
iddhipahutāya iddhi-
visavitāya iddhivi-

and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the possession of superhuman powers, for the mastery of superhuman powers, for the versatility of superhuman powers. Indeed Sirs, whatever samanas or brahmanas in the past exercised the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those did so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers. Also whatever samanas or brahmanas in the future will exercise the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those will do so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers. Also whatever samanas or brahmanas at present exercise the various kinds of superhuman powers, all those do so only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers.

kubbanatāya. ye hi keci bho atītamaddhānaṃ samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā vā anekavihiṭṭhaṃ iddhividdhaṃ paccaṇubhossanti, sabbe te imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā. ye pi hi keci bho anāgataṃ maddhānaṃ samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā vā anekavihiṭṭhaṃ iddhividdhaṃ paccaṇubhossanti, sabbe te imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā. yepi hi keci bho etarahi samaṇā vā brāhmaṇā vā anekavihiṭṭhaṃ iddhividdhaṃ paccaṇubhonti sabbe te imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulīkatattā.

32. Do you, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, also see in me the ability to exercise such superhuman powers?

passanti no bhonto devā tāvatimsā mama pi maṃ evarūpaṃ iddhānubhāvanti?

33. “Yes, great Brahma.”

‘evaṃ mahābrahme’ti.

34. “It is only by the enculturation and the making habitual of these four bases for superhuman powers, Sirs, that I too, have become of such great power, of such great might.”

‘ahampi kho bho, imesaṃ yeva catunnaṃ iddhipādānaṃ bhāvitattā bahulikatattā evaṃ mahid-dhiko evaṃmahānubhāvo’ti.

35. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsittha. idamatthaṃ bhante brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsi-tvā deve tāvatimse āmantesi.

36. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which these three achievements of an opening

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāvañcidam tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsambud-

have been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure. Which three?

37. Here Sirs, a certain one dwells associated with sensual desires, associated with unwholesome dhammas. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, he comes to dwell disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from unwholesome dhammas. For him being disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from unwholesome dhammas, physical pleasure

dhena tayo okāsādhi-
gamā anubuddhā su-
khassa adhigamāya.
katame tayo?

idha bho ekacco saṃ-
saṭṭho viharati kā-
mehi, saṃsaṭṭho aku-
salehi dhammehi. so
aparena samayena
ariyadhammaṃ su-
ṇāti, yoniso manasi
karoti, dhammānu-
dhammaṃ paṭipaj-
jati. so ariyadham-
masavanam āgama
yonisomanasikāram
dhammānudham-
mapaṭipattiṃ asaṃ-
saṭṭho viharati kā-
mehi, asaṃsaṭṭho
akusalehi dhammehi.
tassa asaṃsaṭṭhassa
kāmehi asaṃsaṭṭhassa
akusalehi dhammehi
uppañjati sukhaṃ.
sukhā bhiyyo soma-
nassaṃ. seyyathāpi

arises. From physical pleasure furthers mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, for him being disassociated from sensual desires, disassociated from unwholesome dhammas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure furthers mental pleasure. This, Sirs, is the first achievement of an opening that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.

38. Furthermore, Sirs, here, a certain one's coarse bodily sankharas are not allayed, his coarse verbal sankharas are not allayed, his coarse mental sankharas are not allayed. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of

bho mudā pāmojjaṃ
jāyetha, evameva
kho bho asaṃsaṭ-
ṭhassa kāmehi asaṃ-
saṭṭhassa akusalehi
dhammehi uppaj-
jati sukhaṃ. sukhā
bhiyyo somanassaṃ.
ayaṃ kho bho tena
bhagavatā jānatā
passatā arahatā sam-
māsambuddhena
paṭhamo okāsādhī-
gamo anubuddho su-
khassa adhigamāya.

puna caparaṃ bho,
idhekaccassa oḷā-
rikā kāyasāṅkhārā
appaṭippassaddhā
honti, oḷārikā vacī-
saṅkhārā appaṭip-
passaddhā honti, oḷā-
rikā cittasaṅkhārā
appaṭippassaddhā
honti, so aparena sa-
mayena ariyadham-

dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, his coarse bodily sankharas come to be allayed, his coarse verbal sankharas come to be allayed, his coarse mental sankharas come to be allayed. For him allaying his coarse bodily sankharas, allaying his coarse verbal sankharas, allaying his coarse mental sankharas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure furthers mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, for him allaying his coarse bodily sankharas, allaying his coarse verbal sankharas, allaying his coarse mental sankharas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure furthers mental pleasure. This, Sirs, is the second achievement of an open-

maṃ suṇāti yoniso manasi karoti dhammānudhammaṃ paṭipajjati. tassa ariyadhammasavanam āgamma yoniso manasikāram dhammānudhammappaṭipattiṃ oḷārikā kāyasaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti, oḷārikā vacīsaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti, oḷārikā cittasaṅkhārā paṭippassambhanti. tassa oḷārikānaṃ kāyasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ vacīsaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ cittasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā uppajjati sukham. sukhā bhiyyo somanassaṃ. seyyathāpi bho, mudā pāmojjam jāyetha. evameva kho bho oḷārikānaṃ kāyasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippas-

ing that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.

39. Furthermore Sirs, here, a certain one does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is wholesome. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is unwholesome. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is blame-worthy. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is blameless. He does not wisely understand as it

saddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ vacīsaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā oḷārikānaṃ cittasaṅkhārānaṃ paṭippassaddhiyā uppajjati sukhamaṃ. sukhā bhiyyo somanassaṃ. ayaṃ kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammasambuddhena dutiyo okāsādhigamo anubuddho sukhassa adhigamāya.

puna caparaṃ bho, idhekacco idaṃ kusalaṃti yathābhūtaṃ nappajānāti. idaṃ akusalaṃti yathābhūtaṃ nappajānāti. idaṃ sāvajjaṃ idaṃ anavajjaṃ idaṃ sevitaṃ idaṃ na sevitaṃ idaṃ hīnaṃ idaṃ paṇītaṃ idaṃ kaṇhasukkasappaṭibhāganti yathābhūtaṃ nappajā-

has come to be, this should be associated with. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this should not be associated with. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is inferior. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is superior. He does not wisely understand as it has come to be, this is dark, bright or their counterparts. On a later occasion, he listens to the noble ones' Dhamma. He attends to the root source, and enters upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma. Owing to listening to the noble ones' Dhamma, attending to the root source, and entering upon the path of dhamma that accords with the Dhamma, he wisely understands as it has come to be, this is wholesome. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is unwholesome. He wisely understands as it has come to

nāti. so aparena samayena ariyadhammam suṇāti yoniso manasi karoti dhammānudhammam paṭipajjati. so ariyadhammasavanam āgama yonisomanasikāram dhammānudhammappaṭipattim idaṃ kusallanti yathābhūtaṃ pajānāti, idaṃ akusalanti yathābhūtaṃ pajānāti, idaṃ sāvajjam idaṃ anavajjam idaṃ sevitaḥḥam idaṃ na sevitaḥḥam idaṃ hīnam idaṃ paṇītaṃ idaṃ kaṇhasukkasappaṭibhāganti yathābhūtaṃ pajānāti. tassa evaṃ jānato evaṃ passato avijjā pahīyati, vijjā uppajjati. tassa avijjāvirāgā vijjuppadā uppajjati sukham, sukhā bhiyyo somanassam. sey-

be, this is blameworthy. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is blameless. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this should be associated with. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this should not be associated with. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is inferior. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is superior. He wisely understands as it has come to be, this is dark, bright or their counterparts. For him knowing thus, seeing thus, ignorance is abandoned, noble knowledge arises. From the fading away of ignorance and the arising of noble knowledge, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure further mental pleasure. Just as, Sirs, gladness causes delight to be born. So too, Sirs, for him allaying his coarse bodily sankharas, allaying his coarse verbal sankharas, allaying his coarse mental

yathāpi bho, mudā
pāmojjaṃ¹ jāyetha,
evameva kho bho,
avijjāvirāgā vijjup-
pādā uppajjati su-
khaṃ sukhā bhiyyo
somanassaṃ. ayaṃ
kho bho, tena bhaga-
vatā jānatā passatā
arahatā sammāsam-
buddhena tatiyo okā-
sādhigamo anubud-
dho sukhasa adhi-
gamāya.

sankharas, physical pleasure arises. From physical pleasure furthers mental pleasure. This, Sirs, is the second achievement of an opening that has been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.

40. “These, Sirs, are the three achievements of an opening that have been awoken to by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of pleasure.”

41. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

ime kho bho, tena
bhagavatā jānatā
passatā arahatā sam-
māsambuddhena
tayo okāsādhigamā
anubuddhā sukhassa
adhigamāyāti.

idamattham bhante,
brahmā sanamku-
māro bhāsittha. ida-
mattham bhante brahmā
sanamkumāro bhāsi-
tvā deve tāvatimse
āmantesi.

42. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the declaration of the four establishments of mindfulness has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of the wholesome. Which four?

43. Here Sirs, having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in the body internally perceiving in accordance with the body, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in the body internally perceiving in accordance with the body, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of the body

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāva-timsā yāva supaññat-tācime tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammāsam-buddhena, cattāro satipaṭṭhānā kusalassādhigamāya. ka-tame cattāro?

idha bho, bhikkhu ajjhataṃ kāye kāyānupassī viharati ātāpī sampajāno satimā vineyya loke abhiññādomanas-saṃ. ajjhataṃ kāye kāyānupassī viharanto tattha sammā samādhīyati sammā vipassīdati. so tattha sammāsamāhito sammāvippasanno bahiddhā parakāye ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

of others externally.

44. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in feelings internally perceiving in accordance with feelings, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in feelings internally perceiving in accordance with feelings, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of feelings of others externally.

45. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in states of mind internally perceiving in accordance with states of mind, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in states of mind internally perceiving in accordance with states of

ajjhataṃ vedanāsu vedanānupassī viharati, -pe- bahiddhā paravedanāsu ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

ajjhataṃ citte cittānupassī viharati -pe- bahiddhā paracitte ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti.

mind, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of states of mind of others externally.

46. Having put away worldly covetousness and longing, a bhikkhu abides in dhammas internally perceiving in accordance with dhammas, as an ardent, contemplative and mindful one. Abiding there in dhammas internally perceiving in accordance with dhammas, he rightly attains to samadhi, rightly attains to luminosity. Rightly attaining to samadhi, rightly attaining to luminosity there, he actualizes knowledge and vision of dhammas of others externally. “These Sirs, are the four establishments of mindfulness that have been well declared by the Auspicious One who

ajjhataṃ dhammesu dhammānupassī viharati ātāpī sampajāno satimā vineyya loke abhiññhādomanassaṃ, ajjhataṃ dhammesu dhammānupassī viharanto tattha sammā samādhīyati sammā vipasīdati. so tattha sammā samāhito sammā vippasanno bahiddhā paradhammesu ñāṇadassanaṃ abhinibbatteti. ime kho bho, tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammā sambuddhena cattāro satipaṭṭhānā paññattā

knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the attainment of the wholesome.”

47. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. Having spoken this meaning, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara addressed the Tavatimsa devas.

48. What do you think about that, O honorable devas of Tavatimsa, the extent to which the declaration of the seven requisites of right samadhi has been well declared by the Auspicious One who knows and sees, the Arahant, the Supremely Awakened One, for the enculturation of right samadhi, for the fulfillment of right samadhi. Which seven?

49. Right view, right thought, right speech, right action,

kusalassa adhigamāyāti.

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanamkumāro bhāsīttha. idamatthaṃ bhante brahmā sanamkumāro bhāsītvā deve tāvatimse āmantesi.

taṃ kimmaññanti bhonto devā tāvatimsā yāvasupaññattācime tena bhagavatā jānatā passatā arahatā sammā sambuddhena satta sammāsamādhiparikkhārā sammāsamādhissa bhāvanāya sammāsamādhissa pāripūriyā. katame satta?

sammādiṭṭhi sammāsaṃkappo sam-

right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness. That which, Sirs, is the unique loftiness of mind equipped with these seven factors, this is called, Sirs, noble right samadhi with its supports proper, with its requisites proper. In one of right view, Sirs, right thought comes into being. In one of right thought, right speech comes into being. In one of right speech, right action comes into being. In one of right action, right livelihood comes into being. In one of right livelihood, right effort comes into being. In one of right effort, right mindfulness comes into being. In one of right mindfulness, right samadhi comes into being. In one of right samadhi, right knowledge comes into being. In one of right knowledge, right liberation comes into being.

māvacā sammākam-
manto sammāājīvo
sammāvāyāmo sam-
māsati. yā kho bho,
imehi sattahi aṅgehi
cittassa ekaggatā
parikkhatā, ayaṃ
vuccati bho, ariyo
sammāsamādhi sau-
paniso itipi sapa-
rikkhāro itipi. sammā-
diṭṭhissa bho sam-
māsaṅkappo pahoti,
sammāsaṅkappassa
sammāvacā pahoti,
sammāvācassa sam-
mākamanto pahoti,
sammākamantassa
sammāājīvo pahoti,
sammāājīvassa sam-
māvāyāmo pahoti,
sammāvāyāmassa
sammāsati pahoti,
sammāsatissa sam-
māsamādhi pahoti,
sammāsamādhissa
sammāñāṇaṃ pa-
hoti, sammāñāṇassa
sammāvimutti pa-
hoti.

50. Indeed, Sirs, that which one rightly saying would say: “The Dhamma is well-proclaimed by the Auspicious One, visible in this life, not involving time, inviting eye witness, leading onwards, to be comprehended by the wise, each one for one’s self, open is the door to the deathless,” it will be this here that one rightly saying, would say. For indeed “The Dhamma is well-proclaimed by the Auspicious One, visible in this life, not involving time, inviting eye witness, leading onwards, to be comprehended by the wise, each one for one’s self, open is the door to the deathless.”

51. Indeed whoever, Sirs, is endowed with confirmed confidence in the Buddha, endowed with confirmed confidence in the dhamma, endowed with confirmed confidence in the Sangha,

yaṃ hi taṃ bho sammā vadamāno vadeyya, svākkhāto bhagavatā dhammo sandiṭṭhiko akāliko ehipassiko opanayiko paccattaṃ veditabbo viññūhi apārutā amatassa dvārā ti, ida metam sammā vadamāno vadeyya. svākkhāto hi bho, bhagavatā dhammo sandiṭṭhiko akāliko ehipassiko opanayiko¹ paccattaṃ veditabbo viññūhi. apārutā amatassa dvārā ti.

ye hi keci bho, buddhe aveccappasādena samannāgatā, dhamme aveccappasādena samannāgatā, saṅghe aveccappasādena samannāgatā, ariyakantehi

endowed with the virtues dear to the noble ones. Those among these Magadhan disciples who had died and passed away, who have been born spontaneously on account of their Dhamma training, who, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening, amount to more than two million, four hundred thousand. There are also once returners among them.

But this other population,
“[those] partaking in merits;”
this mind of mine is not
even able to calculate,
for fear of uttering false
speech.

53. This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke. As, O

sīlehi samannāgatā.
ye cime opapātikā
dhammavinītā sātirekāni catuvīsatisa-
tasahassāni māga-
dhakā paricārakā
abbhatītā kālakatā
tiṇṇaṃ saññojanā-
naṃ parikkhayā so-
tāpannā avinipāta-
dhammā niyatā sambodhiparāyaṇā. atthi
ceve ttha sakadāgāmino.

atthāyaṃ⁴⁸ itarā pajā,
puññabhāgāti me mano;

saṅkhātuṃ no pi sak-
komi,
musāvādassa ottapanti.²

idamatthaṃ bhante,
brahmā sanaṃkumāro bhāsīttha. ida-

Bhante, the Brahma Sanankumara was speaking this meaning, for the great king Vessavaṇa, a reflection of the mind arose thus: “Indeed it is ‘marvellous Sir, indeed it is unprecedented, Sir, that there will be such an excellent Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, such an excellent attainment of distinction will be made evident.”

matthaṃ bhante,
brahmuno sanaṃ-
kumārassa bhāsato
vessavaṇassa ma-
hārājassa evaṃ ce-
taso parivitakko uda-
pādi. ‘acchariyaṃ
vata bho. abbhutaṃ
vata bho, evarūpopi
nāma ulāro satthā
bhavissati, evarū-
paṃ ulāraṃ dham-
makkhānaṃ, eva-
rūpā ulārā visesā-
dhigamā paññāyis-
santī’ti.

54. So then, O Bhante, Brahma Sanankumara, having known the reflection in the great king Vessavana’s mind with his own mind, said this to the great king Vessavana:

atha bhante, brahmā
sanaṃkumāro ves-
savaṇassa mahārā-
jassa cetasā ceto pa-
rivitakkamaññāya
vessavaṇaṃ mahārā-
jānaṃ etadavoca:

55. “What do you think about that, O great king Vessavana. In the past too there was such an excellent

“taṃ kimmaññati
bhavaṃ vessavaṇo
mahārājā. atītaṃ pi
addhānaṃ evarūpo
ulāro satthā ahosi,

Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, such an excellent attainment of distinction was made evident. In the future too there will be such an excellent Teacher, also such an excellent proclamation of the Dhamma, such an excellent attainment of distinction will be made evident.”

56. “This, O Bhante, is the meaning of what Brahma Sanankumara spoke to the Tavatimsa devas. The great king Vessavana, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of Brahma Sanankumara speaking to the Tavatimsa devas, having received it in his presence, inform his own assembly. The Yakkha Janavasabha, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the great king Vessavana’s assembly, having learned this in his presence,

evārūpaṃ ulāraṃ dhammakkhānaṃ, evārūpā ulārā visesādhigamā paññāyimsu. anāgatampi addhānaṃ evārūpo ulāro satthā bhavisati. evārūpaṃ ulāraṃ dhammakkhānaṃ, evārūpā ulārā visesādhigamā paññāyissanti”ti.

idamatthaṃ bhante, brahmā sanaṃkumāro devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ abhāsi. idamatthaṃ vessavaṇo mahārājā brahmuno sanaṃkumārassa devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ bhāsato sammukhā sutāṃ sammukhā paṭiggaḥitaṃ sayāṃ parisāyaṃ ārocesi. idamatthaṃ janavasabho yakkho vessavaṇassa mahārājassa sayāṃ parisāyaṃ

informed the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the Yakkha Janavasabha, having received it in his presence, and also having known through supreme knowledge himself, informed the venerable Ananda. The venerable Ananda, having heard the meaning of this in the presence of the Auspicious One, having learned this in his presence, informed the bhikkhus, the bhikkhunis, the male lay disciples and the female lay disciples. So that this life of purity would be just prosperous and successful, well known and widespread, well taught among many people, among devas and humans.”

bhāṣato sammukhā
sutaṃ sammukhā
paṭiggahitaṃ bhagavato ārocesi. idamatthaṃ bhagavā janavasabhassa yakkhassa sammukhā sutvā sammukhā paṭiggahetvā sāmañca abhiññāya āyasmato ānandassa ārocesi. idamatthaṃ āyasmā ānando bhagavato sammukhā sutvā sammukhā paṭiggahetvā ārocesi bhikkhūnaṃ bhikkhunīnaṃ upāsakānaṃ upāsikānaṃ ‘tayaīdaṃ brahmacariyaṃ iddhañceva phītañca vitthāritaṃ bāhujaññaṃ puthubhūtaṃ yāva devamanussehi suppakāsitaṃ.

